> **“THE FUTURE OF MARATHI CINEMA LIES NOT IN BECOMING A SMALLER VERSION OF HINDI CINEMA, BUT IN BECOMING MORE SPECIFIC, MORE EMOTIONALLY CONTEMPORARY AND MORE FORMALLY FEARLESS IN ITS OWN VOICE”**
>
> **MOHIT TAKALKAR,** Director, *Toh Ti Ani Fuji*







DAD’S HERE
Baapya is a comedy about a transgender man, his family and their hijinks gone awry





LIKE OLD TIMES
Tighee is about estranged sisters coming together to care for their ailing mother

digital overload, changing gender roles...” says Takalkar. “What I wanted to explore was not the beginning of love but what happens once the intensity settles. How two intelligent, sensitive people who genuinely love each other can still damage the very thing they are trying to protect. A failed relationship is not necessarily a false one.”

THE POWER OF SIMPLICITY

Sameer Tewari walked around with the script of *Baapya* for two years, seeking takers for the story of a woman who transitions to a man. He initially considered making it in Hindi, but with little headway, he finally produced it himself in Marathi. “Where Hindi cinema plays on grandeur and everything being glitzy and glossy, Marathi is a lot more intimate,” he says. “There are such lovely, simple and emotional stories. Marathi audiences are also open to it.” They certainly responded to *Baapya*, whose scenic Konkan setting and use of humour made the subject accessible even as adept actors like Girish Kulkarni, Rajshree Deshpande, Shrikant Jadhav and Devika Daftardar essayed characters that represent everything Tewari hopes society is. Focusing on multiple relationship dynamics—between age-old friends, husband-wife, father-son, grandmother-grandkid—his film shows how love is the best antidote to the disease of bigotry. “*Baapya* is about being non-judgmental,” he adds.

Marathi cinema’s lush creative spell in 2026 isn’t an anomaly. Just last year, the industry saw a spate of films offering fresh, welcome perspectives. There was *Sabar Bonda* (Cactus Pears), directed by the debutant Rohan Kanawade, the story of a gay man who rekindles his relationship with a childhood friend in his ancestral village, wowing audiences at the Sundance Film Festival. Actor Shivraj Waichal successfully donned the director’s hat with his first feature, *Aata Th-*